



Documents and legalisation: how it works in 9 study destinations

Apostille, consular legalisation and school-certificate recognition — what your destination actually asks for

academgo.com · Warsaw, ul. Złota 7/28

Most failed applications are lost on paperwork, not on grades or money. Apostille, translation and recognition of a school certificate take anywhere from two weeks to three months — and in some countries they cannot be done after you arrive.

This checklist shows what to do at home, before you fly.

The basic pack, needed everywhere

- A passport valid well beyond the end of your programme.
- School certificate and transcript (for master's — degree and transcript).
- Certified translation into the local language or into English.
- English test certificate, if the programme requires one.
- Photos to local specification, health insurance, proof of funds.

One rule matters more than the rest: translations are made **from the legalised document**, not before legalisation. Change the order and you pay for everything twice.

Apostille or consular legalisation

Most applicants can rely on an apostille — but not everywhere.

Destination	What to do with the school certificate	Separate recognition step
Türkiye	Apostille at home, then a notarised translation into Turkish	Denklik Belgesi from the Turkish Ministry of Education (MEB)
UAE	Apostille is not accepted. Consular legalisation: notary → your country's MFA → UAE embassy → UAE MoFA	Equivalency at the UAE MoE (for a university degree — MoHESR)
Malaysia	Malaysia is not a party to the Hague Convention, so an apostille alone does nothing — follow the university and EMGS requirements	Document check inside the EMGS application
Italy	Apostille and translation	Recognition via CIMEA or Dichiarazione di valore, plus pre-enrolment on the University portal
Spain	Apostille and sworn translation	Homologación of the school certificate; for many programmes also a UNEDasiss score and PCE exams
Hungary	Get the apostille early — both the university and the residence permit office ask for it	University requirements for document recognition
Georgia	Apostille and translation	Recognition at NCEQE (from GEL 40) and the ministry's enrolment order
North Cyprus	Apostille at home. An apostille cannot be issued inside the TRNC — it is not a party to the convention	The real question is the degree, not the certificate: see below
Cyprus	Apostille and translation	The entry permit is applied for by the university, not by you

North Cyprus: the honest part about the degree

The TRNC is recognised only by Türkiye. A degree from a North Cyprus university is not recognised in Europe directly. There is one working route: the programme must be listed as YÖK-accredited, and the degree is then legalised through Turkish authorities — sworn translation, notary and an apostille from the competent Turkish body.

Programmes outside the YÖK list are not considered for recognition at all. Check this **before** you pay a deposit, not after graduation.

Timing: count backwards from your start date

- Apostille: a few days to three weeks, depending on the issuing body.
- Consular legalisation (UAE): longer than an apostille — four authorities in sequence.
- Certificate recognition (Denklik, homologación, CIMEA/DOV, NCEQE): two weeks to several months.
- Visa or entry permit: allow about a month of official processing plus the appointment queue.

Rule of thumb: start documents four to six months before the semester begins, and start legalisation together with your application — not after the offer arrives.

Three mistakes that cost a year

- **Translating before legalising.** The translation must be made from the legalised document.
 - **Leaving home without an apostille.** In several countries it can only be obtained in person or by proxy — from abroad it is slower and more expensive.
 - **Paying the deposit before checking recognition.** Deposits are almost always non-refundable.
-

We will check your pack for free. Send us your school certificate and the countries you are considering — we will tell you what is needed, in what order and by when. AcademGo office: Warsaw, ul. Złota 7/28. The first consultation is free.

Free AcademGo consultation: we check your document pack before you apply

AcademGo — study abroad consultancy. All figures come from official university and government sources; check the year of the price list before you pay.